

when she can't do it herself. You'll also know how to reassure and encourage her.

The time taken to complete the [first stage of labor](#) is varied. In a first pregnancy, the prelabor or latent phase can last for over 24 hours. With a second baby, this phase is very short and labor is usually much quicker.

In the second stage of labor, your partner may change position frequently and you will need to help and support her and provide lots of encouragement.

In [the third stage](#), once the baby is born, you may cut the cord. Watching the birth of your baby is likely to be a very emotional experience. Do not worry if you are moved to tears—this happens frequently.